

A Female Crusoe.

If De Foe had only known of a female Crusoe living on an ocean island, he might, perhaps, have wrought out a story superior to his Robinson Crusoe. Alexander Selkirk's brief life on Juan Fernandez was trivial, either in the hardships endured or the difficulties conquered, compared with that of a native woman on an island opposite Southern California.

The Catholic Fathers at South Barbara were transporting the natives of the Island St. Nicholas to the mainland. Among them was a mother who discovered that her babe had been left behind. She begged that the ship might be put back, but the captain refused. She leaped into the sea to swim ashore, but as a storm prevailed, they all thought she was drowned.

Eighteen years after a company landed on the island. They found traces of life, and after long search discovered the woman, and took her with them. The poor mother never found her babe, but had managed to live in comparative comfort, though very lonely. After her long life chiefly in the open air, she could not bear the confinement of a house, and soon sickened and died.